CONCEPT OF GLOBALIZATION

Scholars like Anthony Gidden (1990) a British sociologist conceive globali-zation as “the intensification of worldwide social relations which link distant localities in such a way that local happenings are shaped by events occurring many miles away and vice versa”. Robert Cox an American political Scientist (1994) visualizes globalization from a different perspective. For him, “The characteristics of globalization trend include the internationalizing of production, the new international division of labor, new migratory movements from South to North, the new competitive environment that accelerates these processes, and the internationalizing of state…making states into agencies of the globalizing world”. For some others, “The world is becoming a global shopping mall in which ideas and products are available at the same time”. According to Scholte, globalization refers to processes by which social relations acquire relatively distanceless and borderless qualities so that human lives increasingly play out in the world as a single place.[1]

According to Deepak Nayyar[1], eminent academic and administrator, globalization can be more precisely defined as “a process associated with increasing economic openness, growing economic independence and deepening economic integration between countries of the world economy”.

According to David Held a British political scientist and a notable figure in the field of international relations and others, the understanding of the world as reflected in the idea of globalization is one that is “rapidly being moulded into a shared social space by economic and technological forces and that developments in one region of the world can have profound consequences for the life chances of individuals and communities on the other side of the globe”. Held and his fellow scholars look at globalization as “widening, deepening and speeding up of worldwide interconnectedness in all aspects of contemporary social life…”.[2]

The central point is that under the forces of globalization, the greater part of social life is determined by global processes in which it seems as if national cultures, national economies and national borders are